

PRODUCT TEARDOWN

# Kite by Zerodha

The trading terminal that made  
discount broking India's most profitable fintech

**Rs.8,320 Cr**

REVENUE FY2024

**Rs.4,700 Cr**

PROFIT FY2024 (BOOTSTRAPPED)

**8M+**

CLIENTS AT PEAK

**15%**

NSE RETAIL VOLUME SHARE

INSIDE THIS TEARDOWN

# Six acts. One conviction. The SEBI question nobody wants to answer.

**ACT 01**

**The Paradox**

Zero brokerage. Maximum profit.

**ACT 02**

**The Machine**

Revenue model, flywheel, SEBI risk

**ACT 03**

**The Product**

Trading, charts, watchlists, API

**ACT 04**

**The Cracks**

Analysis isolation, Groww competition

**ACT 05**

**The Bets**

Nudge, AMC, international equities

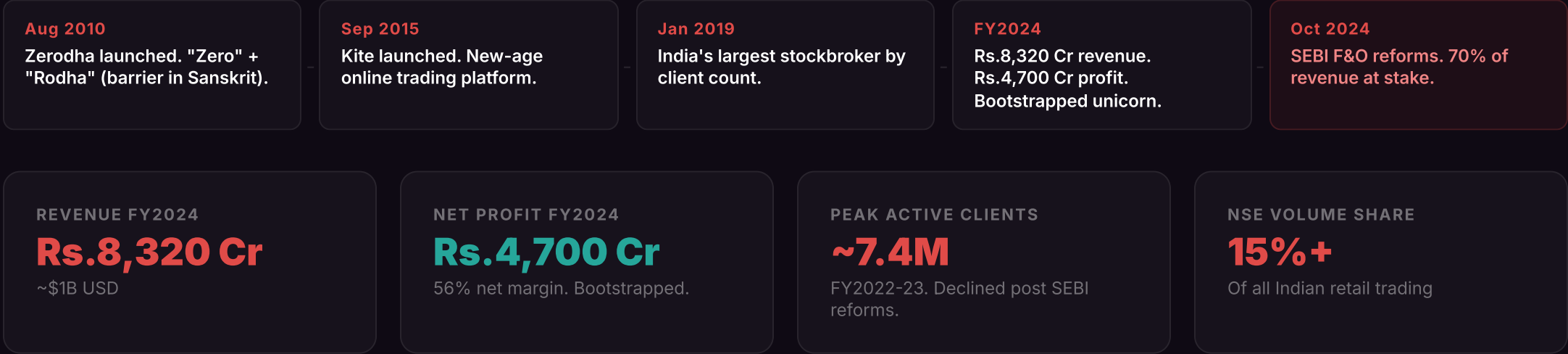
**ACT 06**

**The PM Take**

3 moves: 60 days, 6 months, 18 months

BY THE NUMBERS

# From a 2-person startup to India's most profitable brokerage - without a single rupee of VC funding.



ACT 01

# The Paradox

01

## THE PARADOX

# Zerodha charges Rs.0 on equity delivery and makes Rs.4,700 Cr profit a year. The math only works because of F&O.

The zero-brokerage promise that built Zerodha's user base is structurally irrelevant to its actual revenue. 70% of earnings come from the Rs.20 flat fee on F&O trades - the highest-frequency, highest-loss activity on the platform.

## THE ZERO-BROKERAGE PROMISE

**Rs.0 on equity delivery and direct mutual funds**

This acquired 8M clients. But these users generate almost no direct revenue. They are the acquisition funnel for the real product: F&O trading, where the Rs.20 per trade fee compounds into billions.

## THE REAL BUSINESS

**~70% of revenue from F&O at Rs.20/trade flat**

India's F&O volumes are the largest in the world by number of contracts. Zerodha processes millions of trades daily. At Rs.20 each, the margin math is extraordinary - especially since Zerodha is bootstrapped with near-zero investor pressure.

## THE EFFICIENCY ADVANTAGE

**56% net margin. No VC dilution. No growth-at-all-cost pressure.**

Groww raised \$1B+. Upstox raised from Tiger Global. Angel One runs expensive TV campaigns. Zerodha spends on product and technology - and keeps the difference. Rs.4,700 Cr profit on Rs.8,320 Cr revenue is exceptional for any fintech globally.

THE SEBI MOMENT

# SEBI's 2024 F&O reforms were designed to protect retail traders. They directly struck at 70% of Zerodha's revenue stream.

Zerodha founder Nithin Kamath publicly warned that 9 in 10 F&O traders lose money. SEBI heard him. Then regulated accordingly. The company that built its business on F&O volumes must now survive on fewer, larger, but less frequent trades.

SEBI REFORM: WEEKLY EXPIRIES CUT

**Only 1 weekly options expiry per exchange (Oct 2024)**

Before: NSE had 5 weekly expiry days driving massive daily trading volume. After: reduced to Nifty only. F&O volume on expiry days (highest revenue days for Zerodha) fell sharply. Industry estimated 30-40% volume decline in short-term options.

SEBI REFORM: LOT SIZE INCREASE

**Minimum contract values raised to Rs.15-20L from Rs.5-7L**

Higher entry barrier excludes small retail speculators - exactly the high-frequency traders generating the most brokerage. Each surviving trade is larger but there are far fewer of them. Net revenue impact: significant downward pressure.

THE SURVIVORSHIP ANGLE

**Zerodha's Nudge feature was ahead of regulatory intent**

Zerodha launched "Nudge" - behavioral warnings for loss-making traders - before SEBI mandated similar disclosures. This positions Zerodha as the responsible broker in a regulated cleanup, even if it costs short-term revenue. Brand trust compounds.

ACT 02

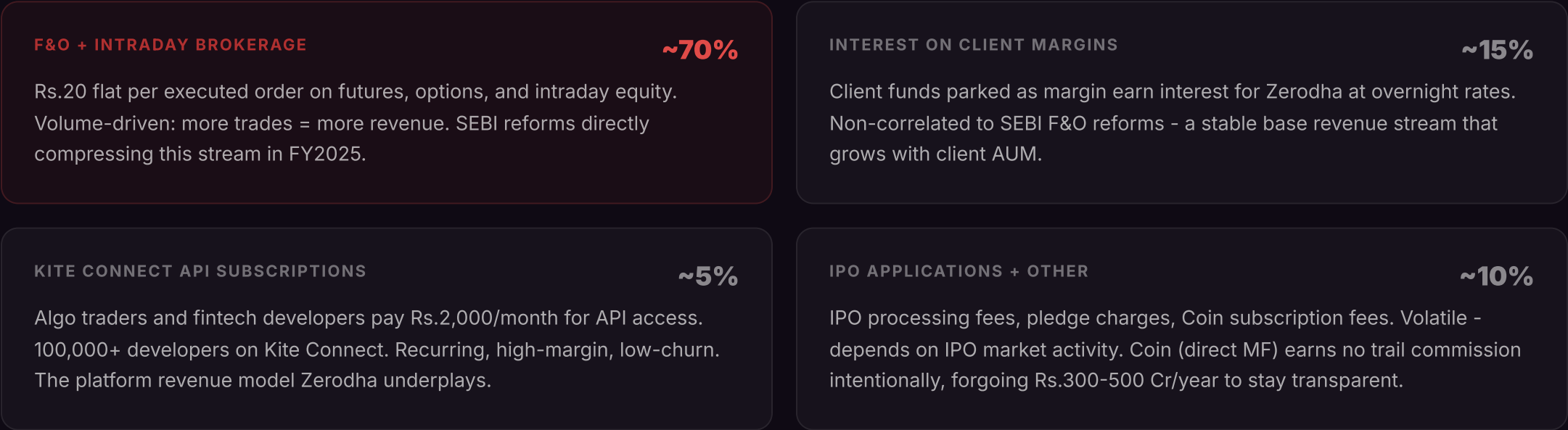
# The Machine

02

BUSINESS MODEL

# Rs.20 per trade is the simplest fintech revenue model in India - and the most vulnerable to regulatory change.

Four revenue streams, but only one does the heavy lifting. The model's elegance is its transparency. Its risk is concentration: when F&O volumes fall, everything falls.





THE ECOSYSTEM FLYWHEEL

# Varsity educates, Kite trades, Coin diversifies, Console retains. Four products. One compounding loyalty loop.

No broker in India has built a comparable education-to-execution pipeline. Varsity graduates become Kite traders. Kite traders diversify into Coin mutual funds. Console surfaces the full portfolio in one view. Each product strengthens the others.

**Varsity - The Top of Funnel**

**India's most comprehensive free financial education platform**

50+ modules, 1,000+ chapters covering equity, F&O, personal finance. Millions of monthly learners. Zerodha's lowest-cost customer acquisition channel: Varsity readers convert to Kite accounts at zero marketing spend.

**Kite - The Revenue Engine**

**Flagship trading terminal. Rs.20/trade on F&O and intraday.**

Available on web, mobile, and API. 15% of NSE retail volumes flow through Kite. Used by everything from first-time investors to institutional algo desks via Kite Connect. The platform that generates the P&L.

**Coin - The Retention Layer**

**Direct mutual fund platform. Rs.0 commission, Rs.0 trail.**

Over 3 million investors. No trail commission intentionally (unlike HDFC, SBI, and ICICI platforms that earn 0.5-1% annually). Creates trust. Users who invest via Coin are 60% less likely to close their Kite account within 24 months.

**Console - The Stickiness Layer**

**Backoffice + portfolio analytics + tax P&L in one view**

Tax P&L reports, tradebook, ledger, CAMS integration for MF tracking. A user who has built their entire financial record in Console has an extremely high switching cost. Console is the data moat that makes Zerodha hard to leave.

THE REVENUE RISK

# Every discount broker in India runs the same model. SEBI just rewrote the rules for all of them simultaneously.

This is not a Zerodha problem - it is an industry problem. But Zerodha is the most exposed because it is the largest and most F&O-concentrated. The companies that pivot to long-term investor revenue fastest will survive the compression.

SEBI OCT 2024 REFORMS - IMPACT SUMMARY

|                               |                                         |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Weekly expiries per exchange  | <del>5 per week</del> <b>1 per week</b> |
| Min contract value (lot size) | <del>Rs.5-7L</del> <b>Rs.15-20L</b>     |
| Upfront margin on expiry day  | <del>None</del> <b>+3% ELM</b>          |
| Estimated F&O volume decline  | <b>30-40%</b>                           |
| Zerodha revenue at risk       | <b>~Rs.2,000-3,000 Cr</b>               |

ZERODHA'S RESPONSE

**Rebalance toward long-term investor revenue**

Zerodha Fund House (own AMC), deeper Coin MF penetration, Kite Connect API growth, and Varsity-driven novice investor acquisition. None of these generates brokerage - they build AUM and subscription revenue instead.

THE SILVER LINING

**Bootstrapped = no investor pressure to grow at all costs**

Zerodha has Rs.4,700 Cr of profit reserves and zero debt. It can absorb 2-3 years of revenue compression while pivoting - a luxury no VC-backed competitor has.

ACT 03

# The Product

03

FEATURE 01 - TRADING

# GTT and basket orders give expert traders a degree of precision no full-service broker can match - at Rs.20.

The expert trader doesn't want advice. They want execution speed, condition-based triggers, and multi-leg orders without friction. Kite's trading layer is built for exactly this persona.

**GTT - GOOD TILL TRIGGERED**

**Set once, execute automatically across sessions**

Conditions remain valid across market sessions - no need to re-enter. "Buy Infosys if it touches Rs.1,400" stays live for months. Expert traders use GTT chains to build systematic entries and exits without being glued to the screen.

**BASKETS - 20 ORDERS AT ONCE**

**Execute complex multi-leg strategies in one click**

Save up to 20 orders in a basket and execute simultaneously. Critical for options strategies (iron condor, straddle) where leg timing affects P&L by hundreds of rupees. No other broker at this price point offers equivalent functionality.

**SHARE GIFTING**

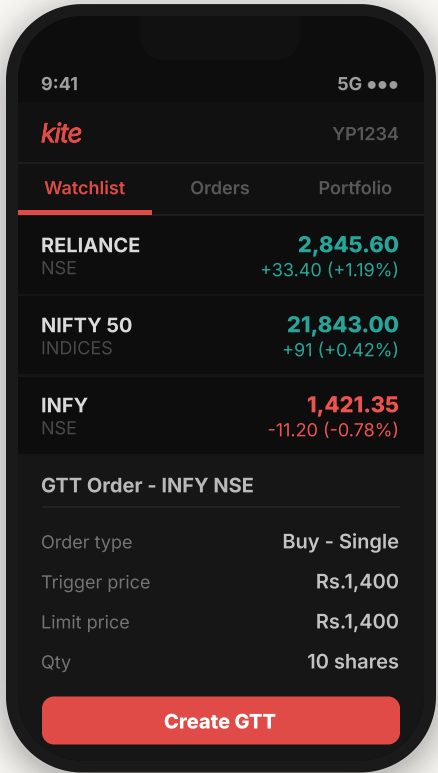
**Transfer equity ownership to any Zerodha account**

Unique feature. Transfer shares to spouse or family for nominal fee - useful for tax planning, portfolio restructuring, succession. Full-service brokers charge Rs.50-200 per gift transaction via complicated demat processes.

**MARGIN AVAILABILITY DISPLAY**

**Know your margin before you place the order**

Shows exact margin required for any derivative trade in the order window. Prevents margin calls and order rejections. Intermediate traders who misread margin requirements lose real money - Kite eliminates this class of error upfront.



FEATURE 02 - CHARTS AND ANALYSIS

# Kite integrates Tickertape fundamentals and Streak technicals into a single pane - no competitor bundles this for free.

Most retail traders use 3-4 separate tools for charting, technical screening, fundamental analysis, and execution. Kite collapses this into one interface. The switching cost it creates is invisible - until you try to leave.

**TRADINGVIEW CHARTS (FREE)**

**Persistent analysis across logins**

Trendlines, indicators, and drawn analysis persist across sessions. Most platforms reset on logout. Kite remembers your annotated chart from last Tuesday - reducing setup friction and improving decision continuity.

**STREAK INTEGRATION - TECHNICALS**

**RSI, MACD, strategy scanning without code**

Streak's no-code backtesting and algo strategy builder embedded in the chart view. Intermediate traders can build "buy when RSI crosses 30 from below" strategies without writing a single line of code.

**TICKETAPE INTEGRATION - FUNDAMENTALS**

**PE, EPS, dividend history, SWOT in one view**

Fundamentals and governance data from Tickertape overlaid on charts. See HDFC Bank's PE ratio trend alongside the price chart. No other free broker gives this quality of fundamental data integrated with live execution.

**MARKET DEPTH**

**20-level bid/ask visibility for serious traders**

The original teardown noted a 5-bid limit - this was addressed. Zerodha now offers 20-level market depth (Level 3 data) for NSE instruments, providing full support/resistance visibility that institutional desks rely on.



FEATURE 03 - WATCHLISTS

# 7 watchlists of 50 stocks each sounds like enough - until you try to run a sector rotation strategy across mid-caps.

Watchlists are the cockpit for every active trader. Kite's implementation covers the basics well but falls short for intermediate traders who want to filter dynamically rather than maintain lists manually.

**WHAT WORKS**

**7 lists x 50 stocks with rearrangeable ordering**

The order of stocks in the watchlist controls the display order in the tracking dashboard. Expert traders who have optimized their watchlist layout are deeply invested - rearrangement is a high-stickiness feature most overlook.

**WHAT BREAKS**

**No filter by sector, market cap, or custom tag**

An intermediate trader running a small-cap IT screen manually updates watchlists. There is no dynamic filter to show "all NSE tech stocks under Rs.500 Cr market cap" without individually adding each. Groww and Dhan offer screener-watchlist integration.

**THE MISSING FEATURE**

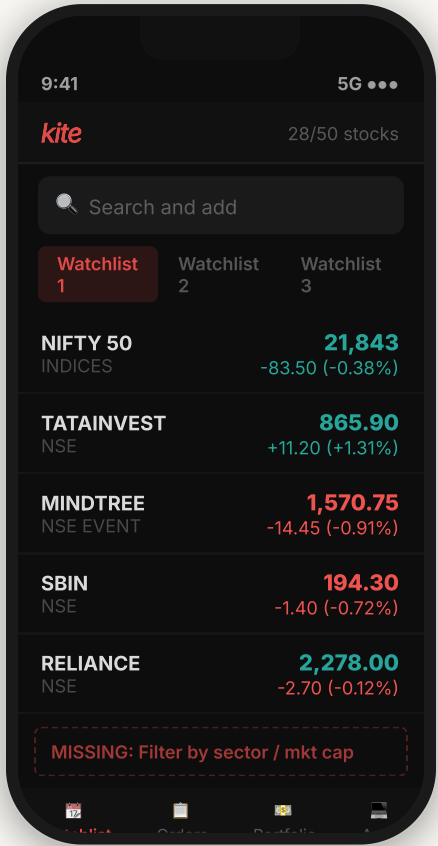
**No multi-parameter filter or smart group**

Zerodha's Tickertape (separate product) has excellent screeners. The logical PM move is to let Tickertape screener results populate Kite watchlists dynamically. The product surface exists. The integration does not.

**THE OPPORTUNITY**

**Stock Tagging would create the missing layer**

Custom tags on stocks ("#earnings-watch", "#pharma-bet", "#rebalance-Q2") enable quick filtering across watchlists without restructuring the list hierarchy. This is a 2-week engineering effort with outsized retention impact.



## FEATURE 04 - KITE CONNECT API

# Kite Connect turned Zerodha's platform into India's largest algo-trading infrastructure layer - and nobody noticed.

100,000+ developers build trading algorithms, retail fintech products, and wealth management tools on top of Kite Connect. They pay Rs.2,000/month. They never churn. And every order they route earns Zerodha Rs.20.

## THE DEVELOPER NETWORK

**100,000+ developers on Kite Connect**

Access to order placement, market data, portfolio, and GTT via REST API. Python, JavaScript, Java, PHP SDKs available. India's most extensive broker API ecosystem - more documented than Angel Broking, ICICI, or HDFC APIs combined.

## THE REVENUE FLYWHEEL

**Rs.2,000/month subscription + Rs.20/trade on every API order**

API users place higher-frequency, larger-volume orders than retail users. An algo strategy may execute 50-200 trades per day. At Rs.20 each, a single active algo account generates more brokerage than 20 retail accounts. Double revenue per user.

## THE ECOSYSTEM BET

**Fintech startups built on Kite are locked into Zerodha**

SmallCase, Sensibull (options analytics), Streak (algo strategies), Leaps&Lags, Rupeezy - all built on Kite Connect. If Zerodha changes API terms, these companies' products break. This is platform leverage no other Indian broker has built.

ACT 04

# The Cracks

04



## CRACK 01 - ANALYSIS ISOLATION

# Kite's chart analysis is brilliant but completely trapped inside a single account. You cannot share it, save it, or discuss it.

The intermediate trader's deepest workflow need is not executing trades - it is validating analysis. They want to share their trendline read with another trader, discuss their entry thesis, and get a second opinion. Kite offers none of this.

**CANNOT EXPORT OR SHARE ANALYSIS****Charts cannot be downloaded, shared, or exported**

Users work around this by taking screenshots and sharing on WhatsApp groups. Zerodha loses visibility into a community behavior that already exists organically - and has no mechanism to bring it onto the platform.

**NO FORUM OR COMMUNITY LAYER****No in-app community to discuss strategies, ideas, or positions**

Zerodha Traders Discord and Telegram channels have 100,000+ members who created these themselves. The community exists. Zerodha doesn't own it. StockTwits, Investopedia, and TradingView (which Zerodha uses for charts) all have community layers.

**CANNOT SAVE ANALYSIS STATE****Cannot save the current view before switching to another instrument**

If you are analyzing RELIANCE's 1D chart with 3 indicators applied and want to compare it with TATA Motors, switching loses your RELIANCE setup. You cannot save a named analysis state and restore it later. Power users report this as a daily friction point.

## CRACK 02 - PRODUCT COMPLEXITY

# Kite is designed for expert traders. This is its greatest strength and its most dangerous blind spot as Groww converts novices first.

Kite's UX assumes financial literacy. Bond search requires ISN codes. Options chains show Greeks without explanation. The learning curve is real - and Groww, Dhan, and Upstox have all designed explicitly for the novice trader that Kite ignores.

**BOND SEARCH - ISN CODE COMPLEXITY****Finding a specific debt instrument requires knowing its ISN code**

Different bond symbols across BSE and NSE create lookup friction. A novice or intermediate investor wanting to add Bharat Bond ETF or Sovereign Gold Bond cannot simply search "gold bond" - they need the exact identifier. Zero guidance provided in-app.

**OPTIONS CHAIN - GREEKS WITHOUT CONTEXT****Delta, theta, vega shown but not explained**

The options chain in Kite shows full Greeks for intermediate users - powerful but overwhelming for the 40% of account holders who have never placed an F&O trade. Groww's options interface explains what each metric means inline. Kite assumes you already know.

**NO PLANNED ANNOUNCEMENTS ON CHARTS****Dividend ex-dates, bonus records, corporate actions not marked on charts**

Sudden price movements caused by dividends, bonus issues, or rights issues appear unexplained on Kite's chart. Users refer to external sources (MoneyControl, BSE website) to understand historical anomalies. This information gap costs real trading decisions.

CRACK 03 - COMPETITION

# Groww overtook Zerodha in active client count in 2024. The novice trader segment that Kite deprioritized is now someone else's moat.

Kite built for experts and won. Groww built for beginners and is now the largest broker by client count. The question is whether today's novice Groww users will migrate to Kite when they become expert traders - or stay on the platform they learned on.

**Zerodha (Kite)**  
**~6.5M**

Active clients (FY2025 est.) - declining from 7.4M peak

Highest revenue per client. Expert-trader focused. Bootstrapped. Most profitable. SEBI reforms hitting hardest due to F&O concentration.

**Groww**  
**7.5M+**

Active clients - overtook Zerodha in 2024

VC-backed (\$1B+). Novice-first UX. Strong MF acquisition. Lower revenue per client but larger top-of-funnel. Expanding into trading from investing.

**Angel One**  
**5M+**

Active clients. Full-service transitioning to discount.

ARQ AI advisory. Strong in tier-2 cities. Listed company with investor pressure to grow. SmartAPI competitive with Kite Connect.

**Dhan**  
**1M+**

Growing fastest. Modern UI targeting Kite users.

Options-first design with OptionTrader. Chart templates, multi-leg strategy builder. Directly targeting Kite's expert user base with better options UX.

**THE REAL RISK**

Zerodha's expert users are sticky - they won't leave for Groww. But Zerodha is not acquiring the next generation of expert traders. Today's novice Groww user has a 60-70% probability of staying on Groww as their sophistication grows, if Groww's product keeps pace.

ACT 05

# The Bets

05

BET 01 - NUDGE: BEHAVIORAL FINANCE IN THE TRADING FLOW

# Zerodha built a feature that discourages its own revenue source. That is either reckless or visionary - and probably both.

Nudge shows warnings to F&O traders who have historically lost money: "9 in 10 traders in this segment lost money last year." No other broker does this. Zerodha is betting that trust - not addiction - is the right long-term retention model.

**WHAT NUDGE DOES**

**Real-time behavioral warnings before loss-prone actions**

Before placing an F&O trade in a category where the user has a historical loss record, Nudge shows a prompt with the user's own P&L statistics and segment-wide loss rates. Opt-out is available, but the friction is intentional. Launched 2022.

**WHY IT'S A BET THAT PAYS**

**SEBI mandated similar disclosures in 2024 - Zerodha was already there**

Zerodha built Nudge two years before SEBI required loss statistics to be displayed. When regulation mandated it, Zerodha looked prescient rather than compliant. Regulatory alignment as competitive advantage is a bet that compounds quietly.

**THE TRUST ECONOMY THESIS**

**Traders who are warned and still continue are more informed - and more loyal**

A trader who Kite warned, who understood the risk, who traded anyway and lost, is more likely to return to Kite than to blame the platform. Informed consent in financial services is a moat that no UX feature can replicate.

## BET 02 - ZERODHA FUND HOUSE AND COIN

# Launching their own AMC while running India's largest direct MF platform is either a conflict of interest or a vertical integration masterclass.

Zerodha Fund House competes with the same fund houses whose products it distributes on Coin. The company is betting that owning the full stack - education, execution, distribution, and product manufacturing - creates a financial services flywheel no single-product competitor can match.

## COIN - INDIA'S LARGEST DIRECT MF PLATFORM

**3M+ investors. Rs.0 commission. Rs.0 trail.**

Coin foregoes Rs.300-500 Cr in potential trail commissions annually to stay transparent. The 3M+ direct MF investors represent the long-term, low-churn segment Zerodha needs as F&O revenue compresses. Average Coin user has a 5-7 year investment horizon.

## ZERODHA FUND HOUSE - THE AMC

**Passive, low-cost funds targeting the Varsity-educated investor**

Nifty LargeMidcap 250 Index Fund, Nifty 1D Rate Liquid ETF - simple, transparent, low-expense-ratio products. Targeting the same retail investor who learned on Varsity, trades on Kite, and now needs a place to put their long-term savings.

## THE VERTICAL STACK VISION

**Varsity educates → Kite trades → Coin diversifies → Fund House manages**

If all four layers work, Zerodha touches the same user at every stage of their financial journey: novice learner to active trader to passive investor to long-term wealth builder. AUM-based revenue from Fund House is structurally different from brokerage - it grows with market performance, not trading volumes.

## BET 03 - INTERNATIONAL EQUITIES VIA GIFT CITY

# India's high-income urban investor wants Apple, Google, and Tesla in their portfolio. Nobody has made this frictionless yet.

The RBI LRS (Liberalisation Remittance Scheme) allows \$250,000/year per person in international investments. GIFT City's IFSC framework is enabling SEBI-regulated brokers to offer US equities. Zerodha has the distribution and the trust to own this space.

## THE MARKET OPPORTUNITY

**LRS remittance for investment: \$5-7B annually and growing**

High-income Indians already invest internationally via Winvesta, Vested Finance, ICICI Direct International. These are \$5-15 per trade platforms with poor UX. Zerodha could offer international equities at Rs.20 flat with Kite-quality execution.

## THE GIFT CITY PATH

**SEBI registered brokers in IFSC can route international orders**

GIFT City IFSC (International Financial Services Centre) allows Indian brokers to offer US stocks, ETFs, and derivatives without the LRS complexity. Zerodha is well-positioned - it already has regulatory relationships, compliance infrastructure, and 6.5M+ trust-loaded accounts.

## THE PRODUCT PLAY

**US stocks inside Kite. Same UX. Same Rs.20 flat.**

The expert Zerodha user already understands Apple's PE ratio from Varsity and Netflix's earnings from their Tickertape study. Adding US execution to the same terminal - without switching to a separate app - is the natural completion of the investment thesis Kite already supports.

ACT 06

# The PM Take

06



## MOVE 01 - SHIP IN 60 DAYS

# Launch Chart Analysis Sharing - let traders export, annotate, and link their analysis to specific trade setups.

The infrastructure is already there: TradingView's chart sharing API is publicly available. Zerodha has existing Kite Connect authentication. This is a 6-8 week integration sprint that converts Kite from a private tool into a social analysis surface.

**WHAT TO BUILD****One-click chart export as PNG or shareable link**

Generate a snapshot of the current chart state (timeframe, indicators, drawn objects) as a high-res image or a permanent link. Share via Kite app, WhatsApp, or copy link. Analysis credit stays with the account that created it - building personal brand for expert traders.

**THE IMPACT****Address the top pain point of intermediate traders immediately**

The original 2022 teardown identified this gap. It still exists in 2025. Every day Zerodha delays, another trader takes a screenshot, posts in a WhatsApp group, and an external platform (TradingView, Dhan) captures the engagement credit instead of Kite.

**THE RETENTION HOOK****Saved analysis templates lock traders into Kite setups**

A trader who has saved 15 named chart templates (RSI-momentum setup, earnings-event overlay, sector-rotation view) has a switching cost that no Rs.20/trade competitor can overcome. Analysis history is the moat - not the execution price.

## MOVE 02 - 3-6 MONTHS

# Build Watchlist Intelligence - Tickertape screener results that dynamically populate Kite watchlists in real time.

The screener and the watchlist are two separate products at Zerodha. They should be one. A trader who screens for "large-cap IT with RSI below 35" should be able to save that filter as a live watchlist - not manually add each result.

## PHASE 1: TICKERTAPE-KITE BRIDGE (MONTH 1-2)

### "Save as Watchlist" button in Tickertape screener results

When a Tickertape screen returns 12 stocks matching criteria, one button creates a Kite watchlist populated with all 12. Static snapshot. Low engineering effort. High user value. Removes the 20-minute manual process.

## PHASE 2: LIVE WATCHLISTS (MONTH 3-4)

### Dynamic watchlists that update as stocks enter or exit the screen

A "RSI below 30, large-cap" watchlist refreshes automatically after market close. Stocks that no longer match are removed. New entrants are added with a notification. This is the feature that converts passive screener users into daily Kite active users.

## PHASE 3: STOCK TAGGING (MONTH 5-6)

### Custom tags on stocks cross-linked to orders, alerts, and watchlists

"#earnings-Q3" tagged stocks surface across watchlists, orders, and alerts in one view. Cross-list filtering without rebuilding watchlist hierarchy. Intermediate traders who manage 50-100 stocks across lists will find this transformative.

## MOVE 03 - 12-18 MONTHS

# Build a Trader Community Platform inside Kite - and use chart analysis sharing as the content layer that makes it valuable from day one.

StockTwits built \$500M+ in value on traders sharing 280-character opinions. Zerodha has 6.5M accounts, a chart sharing infrastructure (Move 1), and India's most trusted broker brand. The moat is already built - the product just needs to be connected.

## THE COMMUNITY LAYER

**Trader forum inside Kite: share analysis, not just opinions**

Unlike StockTwits (text) or Reddit (anonymous), Kite's community would be identity-verified (Zerodha account + PAN), showing actual trading history. "This user has a 68% win rate on Nifty calls over 24 months" is a signal no external platform can provide.

## THE NOVICE ACQUISITION PLAY

**Groww converts novices. Kite's community converts them from Groww.**

A Groww user who gets serious about trading searches for expert analysis. If Kite's community surfaces the best chart analysis from Zerodha's expert users, it becomes the destination for trader education beyond Varsity. Community is Kite's answer to Groww's UX advantage.

## THE RETENTION EFFECT

**Social graph on a trading platform is a 10x switching cost**

A trader who has 200 followers on Kite Community, whose analysis has been cited 50 times, and whose commentary is linked to specific trades they placed - will never leave for Dhan or Upstox. Social identity is the deepest financial product moat in existence.

## FINAL SYNTHESIS

# Kite earned India's traders. SEBI changed the rules.

## Now Zerodha must earn revenue from investors, not just trades.

Chart Analysis Sharing - 60 days

Watchlist Intelligence - 6 months

Trader Community Platform - 18 months

Zerodha built the most profitable fintech in India without VC money, without advertising, and without compromising on product quality. That is an extraordinary achievement. The SEBI reforms are not a threat to that achievement - they are a forcing function. The company that survives on trading volumes must now build the company that thrives on trust, education, and long-term investor relationships. Kite has the brand. The infrastructure is in place. The only question is whether Zerodha moves fast enough to capture the next generation of traders before Groww does.